



Kodak to sell off its film biz

Kodak has announced that it will sell off its print film business, including kiosks that develop photos in order to raise cash

LG has something AV buffs

LG plans to showcase a range of blu-ray players, home sound systems and other home theatre products at IFA, Berlin

Agent 001

Q Xperia S or a Galaxy Note?

I am using a Sony Xperia Ray since the last two months. I am thinking of getting a new phone. I was planning to get an Xperia S but after reading your review on Xperia S and Samsung Galaxy Note I am quite confused as to which phone I should opt for. Can you please help me out?

Tarique Anwar

A Well, your shortlist does have two very different phones. Both have very different characteristics. Let us start with the Samsung Galaxy Note. It has a big display, essentially as a go-between the phone and the tablet. Very good performance, and the ICS update is out as well. Thanks to the bigger screen, it is extremely comfortable to use – typing messages without tripping over spelling mistakes etc. However, the flipside is that it is quite big.

As for the Sony Xperia S, it is a very capable phone, and the ICS update has sorted out the only real issue with the phone – battery life. This is a big screen phone, technically, but still remains controlled form factor wise. Excellent build quality though, but the camera in anything less than perfect lighting is disappointing. Buy this if you find the Galaxy Note a tad too big.

Q The Lens dilemma

I am a freelance photographer based in Mumbai. I shoot portraits, fashion, beauty and weddings too. This query is in regard to getting the best possible shots for my weddings. As we're aware, weddings can be quite tricky to shoot with low lighting situations and getting good shallow DOF shots.

My query is particularly in regards to lenses since I've just recently upgraded to Canon 5D Mark III, so I don't think I need to look further for camera body. Am currently using the kit lens 24 - 105 f/4, but I find f/4 too short on DOF and certain lighting situation, hence would like to upgrade to fast lenses. Now 70 - 200 f/2.8 IS being the ultimate lens but being out of budget as of now, can you recommend any prime lens for may be outdoor couple portraits or candid shots giving the best possible shallow DOF and sharpness to the image.

Romesh Dhamija

A I understand that your style of photography is quite versatile and for that, the 24-104 f/4 IS lens is quite good. However, the lens does lose out in low light and the bokeh area.

While I would strongly recommend replacing the 24-105 with the 24-70 f/2.8, this might not be a feasible option as

the 24-70 has become a hard lens to track down due to extremely low inventory.

Keeping that in mind and the fact that you require bokeh-rich images, and stellar low light performance, prime lenses are definitely the way to go. If you want wide framing on your images, the Sigma 50mm f/1.4 is a stellar lens. The Canon 50mm f/1.4 is a



Sigma 50mm f/1.4

cheaper alternative, but you won't lose much in performance. For tightly framed shots, I cannot recommend the Canon 85mm f/1.8 enough. It is a beautiful lens with great bokeh, I'm not really sure what your budget is since you don't mention it, but the Canon 85mm f/1.8 is around ₹23,000 and the Canon 50mm f/1.4 is around ₹25,000. If you can, I suggest get both. Or invest in the Sigma 50mm and the Canon 85mm.

Q Laptop options?

I want to buy a laptop with a 13.3-inch screen size, an Intel Core i3 processor, at least 2 GB of DDR3 RAM, 320 GB hard disk drive or over and preferably a DVD writer.

Sthita Ra

A It would've been nice to know your budget for the laptop and the intended usage. If you can get your hands on a Dell Inspiron 13z, a laptop that Dell doesn't sell officially any more, it's still a good deal.

Unfortunately, getting a "cheap" (below 40k) 13-inch laptop is becoming a bit of a rarity these days. Since manufacturers are eyeing the 13-inch form factor for ultrabooks going forward, you will have to shell out at least 50k to 60k to get a good 13-inch ultraportable laptop. Considering that price bracket, we would recommend you to take a look at the Acer Aspire S3 or S5, Lenovo IdeaPad U310 or Samsung Series 5 ultrabooks. **f**



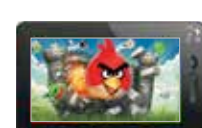
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